Facilities – Special Issue Call

Assessing the Value and Impact of Digital Transformation in the Built Environment

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Key deadlines

Opening date for manuscripts submissions: **02/02/2026**
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Introduction

Despite longstanding work on digitalization in the built environment sector, practitioners frequently question the rationale for adopting digital technologies. From their point of view, digital technologies often represent uncertain investments with unclear returns, limited integration with existing practices, and ambiguous value propositions. Consequently, the burden of proof lies with researchers, managers, and technology providers to demonstrate tangible, measurable, and context-specific value (Fischer et al., 2017).

While digital technologies and PropTech solutions are increasingly used in the built environment (Bröchner et al., 2019; Atkin and Bildsten, 2017; Brozovsky et al., 2024; Tagliaro et al., 2021; Vigren et al., 2025; Tagliaro et al., 2024; Signorini and Pomè, 2025), and research has increasingly focused on the organizational challenges of their implementation (Vigren et al., 2022; Johannes et al., 2024; Bäcklund et al., 2024), the value of digitalization and digital transformation remain insufficiently understood. Research still lacks coherent frameworks for, and evidence of, assessing the value and impact of adopting digital technologies and digitally transforming work for stakeholders in the built environment sector.

This Special Issue aims to contribute to the literature on the value of digitalization and digital transformation in the built environment. Value can be understood as benefits for individuals, organizations, and wider socio-technical systems (Oesterreich and Teuteberg, 2016; Anker Jensen, 2010; Vigren and Eriksson, 2025; Ebbesen and Bonke, 2014; Nyoni et al., 2023). It may be assessed quantitatively through efficiency gains, financial indicators, and key performance indicators (KPIs), or qualitatively through perceived improvements in work practices, decision-making, sustainability performance, and service quality. The Special Issue seeks to identify established and emerging use cases and examine their implications for efficiency, effectiveness, sustainability, and value creation. It also explores why actors adopt digital technologies, how value is conceptualized and measured, and what empirically observed impacts these technologies generate.

We invite contributions from a wide range of disciplines, including facility management, architecture, building engineering, environmental sciences, finance, business and organizational studies, ICT, service design, and policy. Submissions may include case studies, comparative pre- and post-adoption analyses, methodological frameworks, and evidence-based evaluations, offering both qualitative and quantitative insights. Collectively, these contributions will provide a coherent, evidence-based overview of the value of digital technologies in the built environment.

List of Topic Areas

- How the value of digital technologies is conceptualized and measured?
- Opportunities and challenges related to value creation for individuals, organizations, and wider systems
- Adoption and usability of digital technologies
- Economic, environmental, social, and governance (ESG) implications of digital technologies
- Measurable effects (both positive and negative) of digitalization in the built environment

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